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Turkey ski resort fire kills 66, injures 51

DEAD INCLUDE TWO WHO JUMPED FROM HOTEL'S WINDOWS



■ Smoke billows from a 11-storey hotel at a popular ski resort in northwestern Turkey — 170km from capital Ankara — that caught fire yesterday morning.

ISTANBUL

At least 66 people were killed when a huge fire ripped through a hotel at a popular ski resort in northwestern Turkey that was packed with people enjoying the winter holidays, among them families. The blaze also wounded 51 others.

The blaze at the Grand Kartal Hotel in Kartalkaya broke out around 3.30am, sending huge clouds of smoke into the night air and sparking panic among the guests.

Survivors and eyewitnesses spoke of scenes of desperation as people tried to flee the burning building with some leaping out of the windows or

using bedsheets as a makeshift rope.

A very shaken hotel employee said he saw guests at their windows screaming for help. "I saw a father with his baby in his arms asking for pillows so he could throw down his son. Luckily he waited for the emergency services who saved them," he told IHA. "But on the top floor, two women threw themselves out of the window and died," he said, explaining that students were staying on the top floor.

UAE sends condolences

The UAE conveyed its condolences and expressed solidarity with Turkey over the victims of the fire.

In a statement, the Minis-

try of Foreign Affairs (MoFA) expressed its sincere condolences to the government and people of Turkey, and to the families of the victims of this tragedy, as well as its wishes for a speedy recovery for all the injured.

Tragedy struck at peak season for the ski hotel, which stands at 2,000 metres above sea level and was almost full for the two-week winter break which began on Friday.

Turkish authorities said they detained four suspects including the owner of the hotel. "As part of an investigation led by six prosecutors, four people including the hotel owner were detained," Justice Minister Yilmaz Tunc said on X.

—AFP

Neighbours can help reduce stress: Experts

They are a support system and can even save your life

DUBAI

BY ASHWANI KUMAR
Chief Reporter

In today's fast-paced lifestyle, where career demands and daily routines often take priority, building friendly relationships with neighbours can provide crucial support and, at times, even save your life.

Rajendra Singh Yadav's experience underscored the importance of having caring neighbours. Living alone in Dubai, this 50-year-old diabetic man who also suffers from kidney and heart issues, found himself in a life-threatening situation when he struggled to breathe. Desperate, he called his neighbour, Sandeep Chandrani, at 2 am.

He was rushed to the hospital, where Yadav was immediately put on life support and stabilised. Doctors later told him that had he arrived just a few minutes later, it might have been too late. "He saved my life that day," Yadav recalled.

A helping hand

In Abu Dhabi, Charlotte Galardo, an expat from London, shared a similar sentiment. After moving to the city a year ago, she found comfort in the welcoming atmosphere of her building, where neighbours became friends. "Relocating isn't easy, but the kindness of my neighbours has made the transition much smoother," she said.

A psychologist noted that maintaining a small network of trusted neighbours can help reduce stress and loneliness, while also improving emotional resilience.

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Trump pulls US from Paris climate accord

Declares national emergency, troop deployments at Mexico border

WASHINGTON

US President Donald Trump on Monday announced the United States' withdrawal from the Paris climate accord for a second time, a defiant rejection of global efforts to combat planetary warming as catastrophic weather events intensify worldwide.

The Republican leader also declared a "national energy emergency" to expand drilling in the world's top oil and gas producer, said he would scrap vehicle emissions standards that amount to an "electric vehicle mandate," and vowed to halt offshore wind farms, a frequent target of his scorn.

"I'm immediately withdrawing from the unfair, one-sided Paris Climate Accord rip-off," he said to cheering supporters at a Washington sports arena after being sworn in. "The United States will not sabotage our own industries while China pollutes with impunity."

Restrictions on immigration

Trump also announced severe new restrictions on immigration and asylum in the United States, declaring that he will send troops to the US-Mexico border and attempt to end birthright citizenship.

Trump declared a national

KEY DECISIONS

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- Revokes sanctions against Israeli settlers in West Bank.
- Scraps AI safety oversight.
- Pardons 1,500 Capitol rioters.
- Order government to recognise only two biological sexes.

emergency at the southern border and used a careening press conference in the Oval Office to announce the controversial order seeking to revoke the right of US nationality to anyone born in America.

"That's a big one," he told reporters.

The move to reverse a right enshrined in the US Constitution will face stiff legal challenges, an inevitability the president acknowledged.

"I think we have good grounds, but you could be right," he said when asked about the pushback.

Another executive order declared a national emergency on the US-Mexico border.

"I'm fine with legal immigration. I like it. We need people, and I'm absolutely fine with it. We want to have it," he said.

"But we have to have legal immigration."

Earlier, in his inaugural speech, he announced he would be sending troops to the US-Mexico border "to repel the disastrous invasion of our country."

—AFP

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